Keep track of the change

CodeRabbit Change Stack | Formbricks #8650 | Parth Pawar

Make Change Stack easier to review without losing what it can do. I focused on understanding a change, checking its code and keeping track of the review. My starting assumption: as a PR grows, holding the layer, file, explanation and review state together becomes extra work.

What I noticed	What I chose, and why
Summary points share a broad range. Expanding also moves the code.	Keep the original summary wording visible. Expand in place, with a line link beside each statement. Reading and navigation become separate actions; the whole function remains available.
Layers and files are separate. Following a guard leaves a return trip to remember.	Nest files under their layer. Inspect guard opens the dependency; Return restores the caller and position. This keeps one wide code pane; a side-by-side option would need more horizontal space.
Actions span several groups. Seen, viewed and submitted mean different things.	Keep frequent file actions beside the filename and secondary actions in Tools. Mark viewed updates file progress with Undo. Reading a summary never marks the file reviewed.
Message totals, severity and resolution can be read as one signal.	Keep the author, category, severity and line range. Show resolution before the discussion, and collapse replies within the thread. Explicit file/layer scope keeps message totals meaningful; capture coverage is a separate limit.

What I gave up

The original fits more code. This iteration gives files and explanations more room; Focus returns that space to the diff. Smaller highlights may draw attention away from a relevant branch. Inspect + Return also means switching views instead of seeing both files together.

What I kept

The original PR header, merged state, layer order, green/red change counts, finding and complexity labels, J/K and Focus remain. Gray marks selection; orange highlights linked code. Severity and resolution already existed. I changed how they read together, not what the product knows.

What I would test

Compare the same task in both versions, varying which comes first. Watch for missed branches, lost context and buried open findings. Then try a PR with more dependencies. I'd revise panel widths, code links or comment order based on what I learn. Overview filters, summary links after new commits and viewed-state resets need further work.

Observations and assumptions from using this PR, not developer research. Seven of 52 diffs at commit 23cdac2; manually mapped links; one paraphrased finding, with two reply bodies omitted. Secondary workflows are previews. Submit is disabled for the merged PR. Work exceeded the 1–2 hour brief. Paper requires sign-in.

Paper design | Working prototype